Chitula Chipimo

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SUMMARY

Backend and distributed systems engineer with 7 years at Amazon/AWS, including 5+ on **Amazon ECS** across the scheduler/control plane and telemetry. Led the team's technical work at senior-level scope. Since 2024, focused on deep learning, building ML applications and CV-driven automation. Focused on **compute and AI infrastructure**.

SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, Node.js, Kotlin, C/C++, SQL · Spoken: English, French
Infrastructure: AWS (ECS, Fargate, EC2, ELB, Route 53, CloudWatch, IAM, CDK/CloudFormation, Lambda, DynamoDB, SQS/SNS, S3), Docker, observability and telemetry, distributed systems
ML & other: PyTorch, TensorFlow/Keras, deep learning (CNNs, sequence models, transformers), computer vision, robotics, CAD

EXPERIENCE

Career Break: Founder & Independent Engineer · Seattle, WA — Jan 2024 – Present

- **Founded a consumer-hardware startup (LLC, pre-launch):** building an automated 3D print-farm production line using robotics and deep-learning computer vision for manufacturing and QA. Also own product, project management, and trademark/IP work with counsel.
- **Built an AI music-transcription app** that turns piano recordings (MP3, MP4, or MIDI files) into piano sheet music using deep-learning models (Transkun; Kong et al.), developed end to end with Claude Code.
- Completed the **Deep Learning Specialization** (DeepLearning.AI) and **Machine Learning** (Stanford, Andrew Ng). Currently taking Augment's online MBA program.

Amazon / Amazon Web Services · Seattle, WA — Apr 2017 – Jan 2024

Software Development Engineer, AWS ECS Observability — Jan 2021 – Jan 2024

- **Led the team's technical work at senior-level scope:** owned designs end to end and mentored new and junior engineers.
- Designed and built the **ECS telemetry integration with AWS Compute Optimizer**, which powers rightsizing recommendations for ECS workloads; led one junior engineer on the project.
- Designed and launched **Fargate task ephemeral storage metrics**, giving customers visibility into task disk usage through CloudWatch.
- Helped extend ECS telemetry to **Fargate on Firecracker microVMs**, covering both single-tenant and multi-tenant VM models.
- Built an extensible **log-analysis framework** (CLI runbooks, structured queries) for logs of up to **~30 TB/day per region**, cutting ingestion and storage by **35%** on a multi-million-dollar monthly bill. Mentored a teammate to reduce a further **10%** and built a historical-data tool to save another **5%**.
- **Led incident response** for a silent telemetry failure caused by an upstream credential-rotation error: preserved the logs needed to identify affected customers, wrote the COE, presented it to the ECS org, and led the fixes.

Software Development Engineer, AWS ECS Scheduler — Nov 2018 – Dec 2020

- Extended the **ECS health-check grace period** to ELB, Route 53, and container health checks, stopping cascading task replacements for one of ECS's largest customers when brief traffic spikes made healthy tasks look unhealthy.
- Designed and implemented **tagging and tag-based access control for ECS task sets**, giving customers consistent IAM authorization across their ECS resources.
- Volunteered to build metrics, alarms, and dashboards for **AWS Proton** ahead of its re:Invent 2020 launch (Kotlin, CDK).

Software Development Engineer, Amazon Transaction Risk Management — Apr 2017 – Oct 2018

- Helped migrate Amazon to a new real-time fraud-detection service, cutting order evaluation time from minutes to under one second. Resolved hundreds of ML feature mismatches to reach parity with the legacy system.
- Load-tested services before peak shopping events and released excess capacity, saving $20K+/month in hardware costs.

WHOOP · Backend Software Engineer · Boston, MA — Sep 2015 – Mar 2017

- Built WHOOP's serverless order-processing pipeline from scratch (Lambda, API Gateway, SQS, SNS, Shopify, Salesforce, warehouse APIs). It processed thousands of orders worth $250K+.
- Built the cloud storage layer for WHOOP Strap device data (Erlang, S3).

EDUCATION

University of Massachusetts Amherst: B.S. Computer Systems Engineering, Minor in Computer Science — 2015

1st of 21 teams, senior capstone (Faculty & People's Choice awards) · 1st of 83 teams, 2014 Trinity College International Firefighting Robot Contest